

Page 1 of 6 · The Broken Path

Honey-Beats reaches the concert meadow just as the musicians arrive, but the numbered stepping stones are scattered through the tall grass. Flutter-Butter lifts the first three back into a row while Honey taps a rhythm that should lead them to the next neighbour. Sequence: 1, 2, 3, ?



Page 2 of 6 · A Gap by Six

The repaired path carries the first drummer forward, then stops at a gap beside the stone marked six. Honey-Beats taps a steady rhythm while Flutter-Butter counts backwards by one beat. The missing neighbour must return before the rest of the band can cross.
Sequence: 3, 4, ?, 6



Page 3 of 6 · Between Eight and Ten

Near the flower arch, two numbered stones wait with an empty space between them. Flutter-Butter hovers over eight, then ten, while Honey-Beats listens for the beat the counting song has skipped. A xylophone player waits patiently on the bank.

Sequence: 7, 8, ?, 10



Page 4 of 6 · The Twisted Stone

The musicians begin crossing again, but their path curls into a confusing loop. Its number neighbours are in the correct places, yet one stepping stone points differently from the rest. Honey-Beats studies the symbols while Flutter-Butter keeps the band from following the muddled direction.

Read the three front stones from left to right. The left paw print points towards the stage. The middle paw print points away from the stage. The right paw print points towards the stage.



Page 5 of 6 · Neighbours of Fifteen

At the final bend, the stone marked fifteen sits alone between two muddy spaces. Flutter-Butter searches for the neighbour that belongs before it, and Honey-Beats searches for the one after it. Both are needed to reconnect the path to the concert stage. Sequence: 14, 15, ?



Page 6 of 6 · The Concert Path

The stage lights glow, but the last stepping-stone space is still empty after seventeen, eighteen, nineteen. Every musician waits together at the edge of the meadow.

Honey-Beats begins a rising counting song, and Flutter-Butter listens for the number that will finish the path.

Sequence: 17, 18, 19, ?

Questions for Honey-Beats and the Number Neighbours

Read the story together first. Use the page prompts and the questions after reading. Answers are below the dotted line: fold them under or cover them while reading.

Page 1 · The Broken Path

Which number comes after 3?

Sequence: 1, 2, 3, ? Choices: 2 · 4 · 5

Page 2 · A Gap by Six

Which number comes before 6?

Sequence: 3, 4, ?, 6 Choices: 4 · 5 · 7

Page 3 · Between Eight and Ten

Which number belongs between 8 and 10?

Sequence: 7, 8, ?, 10 Choices: 8 · 9 · 11

Page 4 · The Twisted Stone

Which stone is turned the wrong way?

Read the three front stones from left to right. The left paw print points towards the stage. The middle paw print points away from the stage. The right paw print points towards the stage. Choices: The left front stone · The middle front stone · The right front stone

Page 5 · Neighbours of Fifteen

Which pair are the neighbours of 15?

Sequence: 14, 15, ? Choices: 13 and 14 · 14 and 16 · 16 and 17

Page 6 · The Concert Path

Which number finishes the path?

Sequence: 17, 18, 19, ? Choices: 18 · 20 · 21

After reading

What are the neighbours of a number?

Answers (fold under before reading)

Page 1: 4. Four follows three.

Page 2: 5. Five lives between four and six.

Page 3: 9. Nine is the neighbour between eight and ten.

Page 4: The middle front stone. The reversed stone was interrupting the pattern.

Page 5: 14 and 16. Fourteen and sixteen are beside fifteen.

Page 6: 20. Twenty completes the concert path.

After reading: The number just before it and the number just after it. The neighbours of 15 are 14 and 16.

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